India

The South Asian country of India takes its name from the Indus River but the land is often referred to as Bharata. This is a reference to a legendary emperor whose tale is retold somewhat within the Mahabharata. The fifth century CE texts called the Puranas tell us how Bharata managed to seize control over India and ruled peacefully for many years. This is why India was once called Bharatavarsha. The archaeological record shows that the earliest human ancestors lived in India for 250,000 years, making it one of the oldest occupied areas around the world.

Archaeological findings have unearthed a variety of artifacts that were used by the earliest humans including various kinds of stone tools. Ancient India is often overlooked while other ancient civilizations such as Egypt, Rome and Greece are praised for contributing to various academic areas.